

SUBSURFACE AGENCY

O-1B VISA

Application Evidence & Preparation Pack

Prepared for legal counsel and immigration advisors

Prepared by:

Subsurface Agency | Ideas HQ Ltd

Company No. 10669734 | Registered in England & Wales

Date Prepared: April 2025

1. Introduction & Purpose of This Pack

This document has been prepared by Subsurface Agency (operated by Ideas HQ Ltd) to support an O-1B visa application for a team of professional videographers and content production specialists seeking to work legally with US-based clients within the geothermal and subsurface energy industry.

This pack is intended to serve as a comprehensive evidence and briefing document when engaging an immigration lawyer or visa specialist. It brings together:

- A summary of the O-1B visa category and its relevance to our team
- An overview of Subsurface Agency, its credentials and industry specialism
- A catalogue of evidence supporting extraordinary ability claims
- Research on potential legal counsel and immigration agencies
- A breakdown of government fees and estimated total costs
- A checklist of documents still to be gathered

NOTE: This pack is a working document and a starting point for legal consultation. Nothing in this document constitutes legal advice. All visa strategy and final submission decisions should be made in consultation with a qualified US immigration attorney.

2. O-1B Visa Overview

2.1 What is the O-1B Visa?

The O-1B visa is a US non-immigrant visa category for individuals who possess extraordinary ability in the arts, or extraordinary achievement in motion picture or television industry. It is the appropriate category for professional videographers, film and photography leads, and creative directors in the content production space.

2.2 Who Qualifies?

To qualify, the applicant must demonstrate extraordinary ability by satisfying at least three of the following criteria, or by demonstrating a one-time achievement equivalent to a major international award:

O-1B Criteria	How It May Apply to Our Team
Critical role for distinguished organisations	Work embedded with leading geothermal drilling companies
High salary relative to peers	Day rates of £1,400–£4,800 demonstrably above market average
Recognition by peers / press	Industry features, interviews, trade publications
Original contributions of major significance	Pioneering visual content in specialist geothermal sector
Performed / judged work for others of distinction	Clients and organisations of note in the energy sector
Commercial success relative to others	Revenue, client contracts, project scope and fees
Awards or prizes	Industry awards, nominations, client testimonials

2.3 Petitioner Requirements

An O-1B visa must be petitioned by a US employer, agent, or organisation. A US-based entity must file the I-129 petition on behalf of the applicant(s). Options include:

- A US-based geothermal client acting as petitioner
- A US agent or management company filing on our behalf
- A US affiliate or legal entity established for this purpose

***ACTION REQUIRED:** Identify a willing US petitioner before engaging legal counsel. This is the single most important prerequisite for the O-1B process. Discuss with US clients in the geothermal sector who have expressed interest in working with Subsurface.*

3. About Subsurface Agency

3.1 Company Profile

Field	Detail
Legal Name	Ideas HQ Ltd
Trading Name	Subsurface Agency
Company Number	10669734
Registered In	England & Wales
Website	subsurface.agency
Sector	Specialist creative agency – geothermal and subsurface energy industry
Services	Video production, photography, 3D visualisation, content strategy, training materials, brand ide

3.2 Industry Specialism

Subsurface Agency is a specialist creative and content production agency serving the ground-source heat pump (GSHP) and geothermal drilling sector. Unlike generalist agencies, Subsurface operates with deep technical knowledge of:

- Drilling operations and equipment
- Geothermal energy systems and GSHP installations
- Product USPs for subsurface energy technology
- Technical content creation for a specialist B2B audience

This specialism is core to the O-1B extraordinary ability argument: our team's work does not merely produce video content — it requires fluency in a complex technical field that very few creative professionals possess.

3.3 Service Tiers (Rate Card Summary)

Role	Day Rate Range	Tier
Executive Creative Director	£2,800 – £4,800/day	Tier 1
Executive Innovation & Production Director	£2,800 – £4,800/day	Tier 1
3D & Virtualisation Director	£2,000 – £3,500/day	Tier 1
Training & Workforce Development Director	£1,800 – £3,200/day	Tier 1
Executive Editor	£1,600 – £3,200/day	Tier 1
Film & Photography Lead	£1,400 – £2,600/day	Tier 1
Agency Creative Services	£500 – £950/day	Tier 2

4. Evidence Catalogue for O-1B Application

The following outlines the categories of evidence required and the specific items to compile. Items marked [READY] are available or in preparation; items marked [DRAFT] are still to be gathered.

4.1 High Salary / Remuneration Evidence

- [READY] 2025 UK Rate Card document (Subsurface Agency)
- [DRAFT] Comparison of our day rates against industry benchmarks (e.g. BECTU, freelancer rate surveys)
- [DRAFT] Copies of signed contracts or invoices demonstrating rates charged to clients
- [DRAFT] Bank statements or accounting records confirming receipt of payments at these rates

4.2 Critical or Essential Role for Distinguished Organisations

- [DRAFT] Client letters confirming the critical nature of Subsurface's contribution
- [DRAFT] Project briefs, scopes of work, or contracts naming Subsurface as a key creative partner
- [DRAFT] Case studies demonstrating campaigns central to client activity
- [DRAFT] Testimonials from senior stakeholders at geothermal companies (ideally US-based)

4.3 Original Contributions of Major Significance

- [DRAFT] Portfolio demonstrating innovative approaches to geothermal content production
- [DRAFT] Evidence of unique methodologies — e.g. bespoke 3D visualisation for underground drilling
- [DRAFT] Articles, case studies or blog content authored by the team on specialist topics
- [DRAFT] Evidence of training materials developed for the sector

4.4 Recognition by Industry Peers

- [DRAFT] Press coverage or features in geothermal / energy / B2B media
- [DRAFT] Invitations to speak at industry events or conferences
- [DRAFT] Expert commentary provided to trade publications
- [DRAFT] Social media engagement from recognised industry figures

4.5 Commercial Success / Track Record

- [READY] Rate cards demonstrating sustained high-value day rates
- [DRAFT] Revenue history and client list demonstrating breadth of commercial activity
- [DRAFT] Examples of projects delivered with documented outcomes (views, reach, business impact)

4.6 Awards & Prizes

- [DRAFT] Any film, production or creative awards received
- [DRAFT] Award nominations
- [DRAFT] Client recognition programmes or internal awards from major organisations

4.7 Peer Review / Judging

- [DRAFT] Evidence of evaluating the work of others (e.g. judging panels, advisory roles)
- [DRAFT] Guest lectures or training delivered to industry professionals

TIP FOR LEGAL COUNSEL: We are specialists in a narrow technical niche. Even if we do not satisfy all criteria strongly, the 'extraordinary within the field' bar may be met by demonstrating we are among a very small number of production professionals globally who operate at this level within geothermal. Our legal representative should argue field-specific extraordinariness.

5. Immigration Legal Counsel Research

The following agencies have been identified as potential legal representatives for the O-1B application. This research was conducted internally and should be further vetted before engagement.

Agency	Website	Location	Notes
Sidman Law Group	sidmanlawgroup.com	US – Los Angeles	O-1B specialists. Recommended by industry contact. James wa
Deel (Immigration)	deel.com	Remote / Global	Reports 90%+ approval rate. Initial consultation chargeable. Lar
Barella Global	barellalaw.com	UK & Brussels	O-1B experience. 5-star Google reviews. UK-based for coordin
Flynn Hodkinson	flynnhodkinson.com	London, UK	4.8 stars on Google. Further research needed on O-1B specialis
Birch Visas	birchvisas.co.uk	UK	US visa specialists from UK. To be researched further.
Total Law	total.law	US, UK, Ireland, Canada	Multi-jurisdiction. Covers O-1 visas. Good for cross-border situa

5.1 Questions to Ask Legal Counsel

1. Have you successfully obtained O-1B visas for clients in creative production / film?
2. Do you have experience with applicants from the UK applying to work with US-based clients?
3. Who would act as the US petitioner, and can you help us structure that arrangement?
4. What is your fee structure and what is included (petition drafting, RFE response, etc.)?
5. What is your average processing time and success rate for O-1B applicants?
6. Do you recommend Premium Processing for our timeline?
7. What is your assessment of our strongest evidence categories?

6. Cost Breakdown

6.1 Government (USCIS) Fees

The following fees are payable directly to the US government as part of the visa petition process. These fees apply per applicant (Form I-129).

Fee Item	Amount (USD)	Notes
USCIS Form I-129 Filing Fee	\$530	Businesses with fewer than 25 employees
Asylum Program Fee	\$300	Small employers (\$600 for larger)
Visa Integrity Fee	\$250	
DS-160 Visa Interview Fee	\$205	Paid after petition approval at consulate
Standard Total (approx.)	\$1,285	Per applicant, excluding premium processing
Premium Processing (Optional)	\$2,805	USCIS reviews within 15 business days
Total with Premium Processing	\$4,090	Recommended for time-sensitive projects

6.2 Legal Fees

Legal fees vary significantly by firm and complexity. Based on market research:

Item	Estimated Range
Attorney / Legal Counsel Fees	\$5,000 – \$15,000 per applicant
Government Fees (standard)	\$1,285 per applicant
Premium Processing (optional)	\$2,805 per applicant
ESTIMATED TOTAL PER APPLICANT	\$8,090 – \$21,090

NOTE: For a team application, costs multiply per applicant. Some law firms offer reduced rates for multiple simultaneous petitions — raise this during initial consultations. Premium Processing is strongly recommended if you have a specific project start date in mind.

6.3 Additional Costs to Budget

- Travel to US consulate for visa interview (if required)
- Potential Response to Evidence (RFE) legal fees if USCIS requests more information
- Translation of any non-English documents
- Notarisation of documents
- Agent or petitioner administrative costs (if using a US agent entity)

7. Action Plan & Next Steps

The following steps should be completed in priority order to advance the O-1B application.

#	Action	Owner	Priority
1	Identify and confirm a US-based petitioner (client, agent or entity)		CRITICAL
2	Contact Sidman Law Group for initial consultation	James	HIGH
3	Request consultations from 2–3 additional firms for comparison		HIGH
4	Compile signed contracts and invoices demonstrating day rate history		HIGH
5	Gather client reference letters (ideally from US geothermal clients)		HIGH
6	Compile portfolio evidence with documented outcomes and impact		MEDIUM
7	Obtain industry salary benchmarks to support high remuneration claim		MEDIUM
8	Collect any press coverage, trade mentions, or speaking invitations		MEDIUM
9	Begin budgeting for legal fees and government fees per applicant		MEDIUM
10	Assess whether to incorporate a US entity or use an agent structure		MEDIUM
11	Confirm number of team members requiring visa sponsorship		LOW

8. Document Checklist

Use this checklist to track the status of all evidence and documents required. Share with your legal counsel at the first meeting.

Document	Status	Owner
Company & Identity Documents		
Companies House registration certificate		
Subsurface Agency 2025 Rate Card	READY	
Passports for all applicants		
CVs / professional biographies for all applicants		
Financial Evidence		
Recent contracts / signed agreements with clients		
Invoices demonstrating day rate billing		
Bank statements confirming payment receipt		
Industry salary / rate benchmarks for comparison		
Client & Peer References		
Reference letters from named clients (ideally US-based)		
Testimonials confirming critical / essential role		
Letters from industry professionals confirming standing		
Portfolio & Creative Evidence		
Showreel / video portfolio		
Case studies with documented outcomes		
Samples of training materials produced		
Examples of 3D visualisations / technical creative work		
Recognition & Achievements		
Press coverage / trade media mentions		
Award certificates or nominations		
Conference / speaking invitations		
Evidence of judging or evaluation roles		
US Petitioner Documents		

US petitioner entity name and details		
Signed itinerary or scope of planned US work		
US petitioner's IRS / EIN documentation		

9. Key Contacts & References

9.1 Subsurface Agency

Field	Detail
Company	Ideas HQ Ltd t/a Subsurface Agency
Website	subsurface.agency
Company No.	10669734

9.2 Legal Counsel Contacts

Firm	Website	Notes
Sidman Law Group	sidmanlawgroup.com	First priority. Industry recommendation via James.
Deel Immigration	deel.com/hr-services/...	Free consultation available online.
Barella Global	barellalaw.com	UK-based. 5-star reviews.
Flynn Hodkinson	flynnhodkinson.com	London, UK. 4.8-star rating.
Birch Visas	birchvisas.co.uk	US from UK specialism.
Total Law	total.law	Multi-jurisdiction: UK, US, Ireland, Canada.

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